[LIT-FLK-015] Shawon Kala Ngayirwon

Translation: The Legend of the Mountain Orchid and the Silver Cascade

Work Type: FOLK_TALE | Creator: Phangrei Oral Tradition Custodians | Year: 1977
Village: Phangrei | Dialect: Standard Tangkhul | Book ID: None
Publisher / Source: Tangkhul Literature Society / Documented in Horam
Clearance: Traditional Oral Heritage | Permission: community_authorized | Status: verified

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Themes: Tragic mountain romance and star-crossed sweethearts (*Khararchan Leikashi*), Botanical metamorphism into wild mountain orchids (*Shawon

Structure & Meter: Poetic legend in alternating eight-line rhymed couplets with antiphona

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Critical Overview: A beloved topographical legend tied to the scenic cliffs and waterfalls of Phangrei. It reflects the Tangkhul cultural tradition of

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Indigenous Tangkhul Literary Text / Stanzas:

Phangrei kaphung khangacheili pamnao mayarnao eina shanaonao akha, ningk
Kha shimwui ngashan eina ram kachishat wui vangli, ani leishat chiteikha
Ngayir kaphung lung-ngakui eili shanaonaona kacham-kacham mik-kathi phor
'I-leishatnao mayarnao, ngaleili ngasamphang-khamakha, kazeiramwui kaphu
Mayarnaona shanaonaowui mik-kathi kharorli samphanglaga, lungrei-li kash
Chitharan ani pamkakhung lungkui-li meikhangao thada Shawon won khamatha

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English Translation & Literary Rendering:

Upon the rolling green crests of Phangrei highlands lived two devoted vi
Yet cruel clan divides and ancient village disputes barred their customa
Weeping upon the sheer cliff edge where the silver waterfall leaps into
'O my beloved, if we cannot walk together beneath these terrace skies, i
Reaching out his hand across the rocky promontory, the brave youth embra

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Key Poetic & Literary Vocabulary Terms:

* Shawon : Wild alpine orchid blooming on high cliff faces an
* Ngayir : Leaping mountain cascade / silver waterfall
* Lungrei : Ancestral stone monolith / sacred rocky mountain c

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